

Media Library

User Guide

Version 1.0 | For Windows 10 and Windows 11

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1. Welcome

Media Library keeps track of the video files you store across your hard drives. It builds a catalogue of every folder and scene, so you can browse, search, rate and play your whole collection from one place.

The catalogue lives on your PC, which means you can still browse everything when a drive isn't connected. You'll only need the drive when you want to play or change a file.

What you can do

- **Browse** folders and scenes as picture tiles, and preview a scene by moving the mouse across it.
- **Find** anything with search, filters and saved filters.
- **Organise** with ratings, tags and your own categories.
- **Explore** your collection through the Performers window and Dashboard.
- **Tidy up** by finding duplicates, leftovers and scenes you no longer want.
- **Protect** your catalogue with safety copies on another drive, and an optional PIN.

What you need

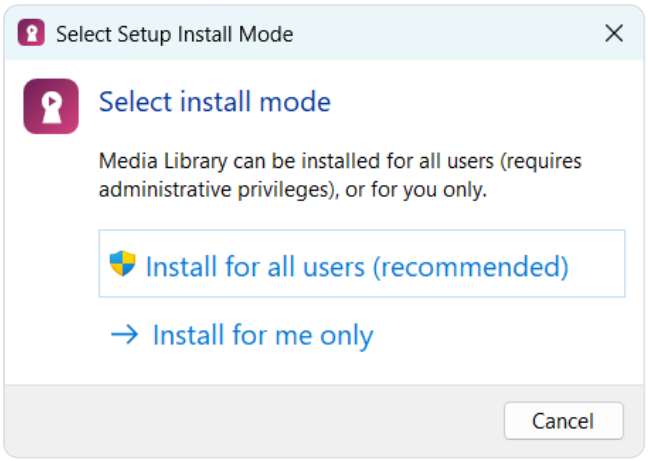
Item	Requirement
Operating system	Windows 10 version 1809 or later, or Windows 11 (64-bit)
Disk space	About 500 MB for the app, plus room for your catalogue and screenshots
Video player	Scenes open in your Windows default video player

You also need **ffmpeg**, a free program that reads your videos and takes their screenshots. It isn't included with the app, and the next chapter shows how to get it.

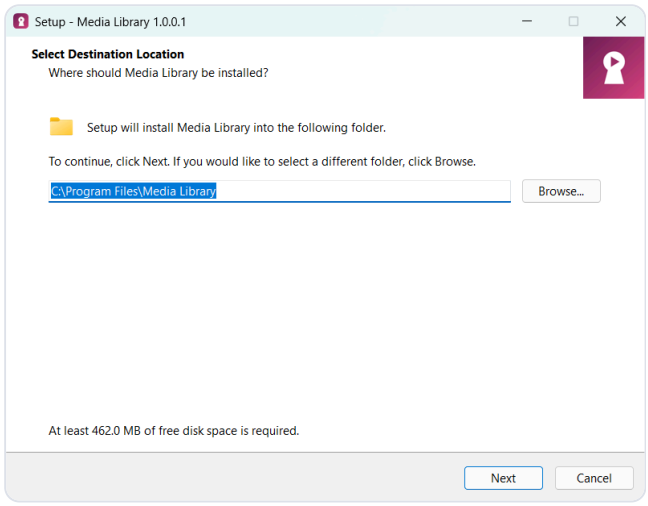
2. Getting started

Installing

1. Double-click the setup file.
2. Choose **Install for all users** or **Install for me only**. Installing for everyone needs an administrator password.
3. Accept the suggested folder, or choose another, and click **Next**.
4. Tick **Create a desktop shortcut** if you'd like one, then click **Next** and **Install**.
5. Click **Finish**. Leave **Open Media Library** ticked to start it straight away.



Choosing who to install for



Choosing where to install

> **If Windows shows a warning**
> Windows can show a SmartScreen message for newly released apps. If you trust where you got the installer, choose **More info**, then **Run anyway**.

Getting ffmpeg

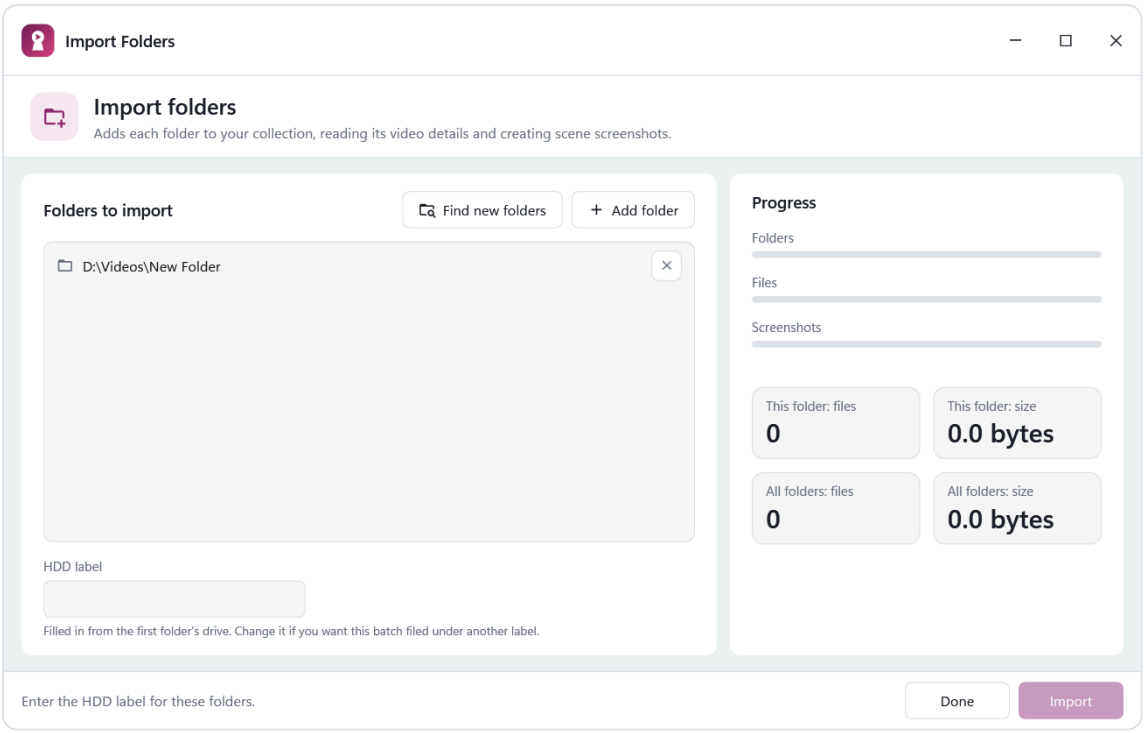
Until ffmpeg is set up, an **ffmpeg needed** button shows in the status bar, and anything that reads a video asks for it first.

1. Click **ffmpeg needed**, then **Open download page**, and choose a Windows release build.
2. Unzip it to a folder that will stay put, such as `C:\ffmpeg`.
3. Click **Choose folder...** and pick its `bin` folder, which holds `ffmpeg.exe` and `ffprobe.exe`. If ffmpeg is already installed, **Find it** looks in the usual places.

Adding your first folder

1. Choose **File > Import Folder(s)...**

2. Click **Add folder**, or drag folders into the window. To pick up several at once, click **Find new folders**, choose one connected drive and search it: Media Library looks beside the folders you already have on that drive, and you tick the ones to add. Every folder needs its own name across your collection, even on different drives, so a folder whose name is taken can't be added until you rename it on the drive.
3. Check the **HDD label**. It's filled in from the drive, and you can change it if this batch belongs under another label.
4. Click **Import**. Media Library reads each video and takes its screenshots.



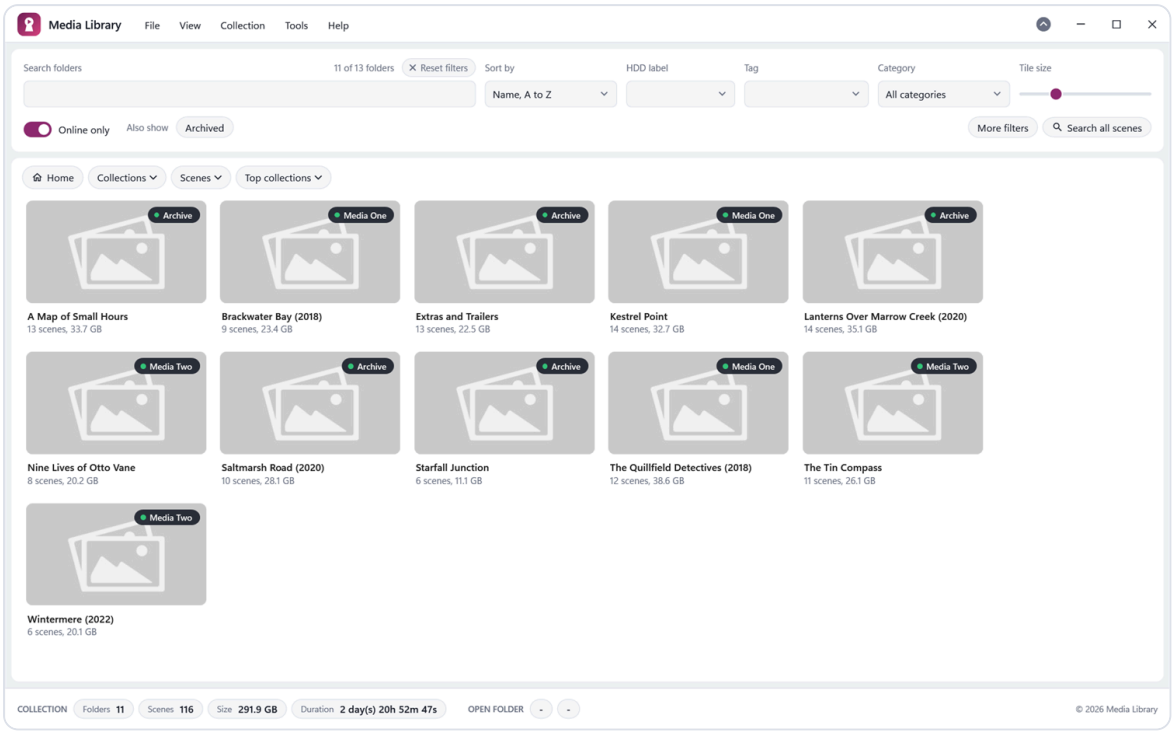
The Import Folders window

> **Your videos aren't moved**
> Importing only adds them to the catalogue. Your files stay exactly where they are.

Uninstalling

Use **Settings > Apps** in Windows, or **Uninstall Media Library** in the Start menu. This removes the app only. Your catalogue, ratings and videos stay in place, so reinstalling picks up where you left off.

3. A tour of the main window



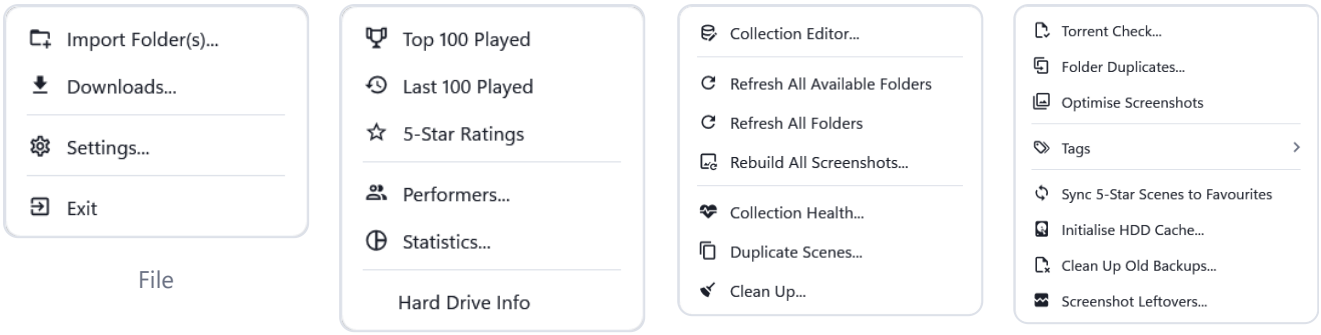
The main window showing folders

The menus

Menu	What's there
File	Import folders, Downloads, Settings and Exit
View	Top 100 Played, Last 100 Played, 5-Star Ratings, Performers, Dashboard and Hard Drive Info
Collection	Collection Editor, refreshing folders, Collection Health, Duplicate Scenes and Clean Up
Tools	Torrent Check, Folder Duplicates, Optimise Screenshots, Favourites sync, copying to a drive and clean-up tools
Help	User Guide, Check for Updates, System Information and About

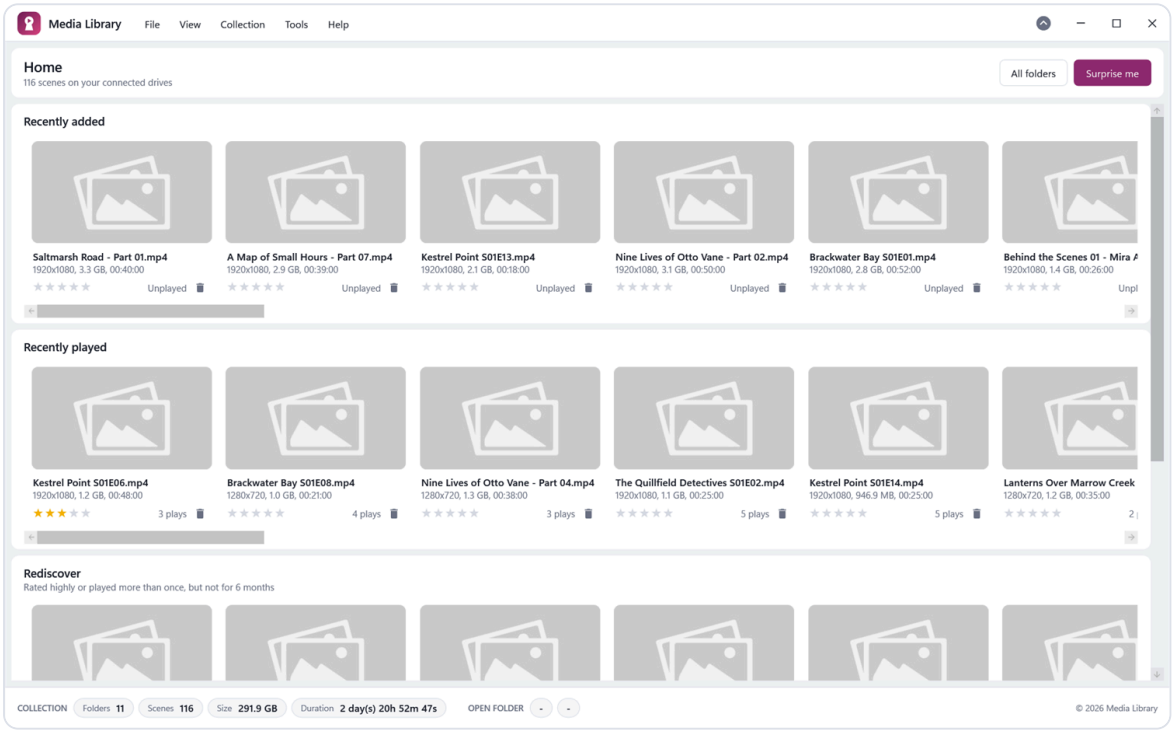
Your own folder details

Use **Settings** > **Attributes** to add details of your own to folders and scenes, such as Studio, Publisher or Released Year, as text, a number or a date. Fill them in from Edit Details, or for several scenes at once from the selection bar. Each one becomes a filter for folders, under **More filters**, and for scenes. Scenes can go in categories of their own too. A scene counts as having its folder's categories and attributes, and a value set on the scene takes priority. Hiding an attribute takes it out of view without changing the values held.



Home

Home brings together recently added scenes, what you've played lately, highly rated scenes you haven't watched for six months, and a random handful you've never played. **Surprise me** plays a random scene, choosing from your top-rated ones if you have any. **All folders** takes you back to the folder tiles.

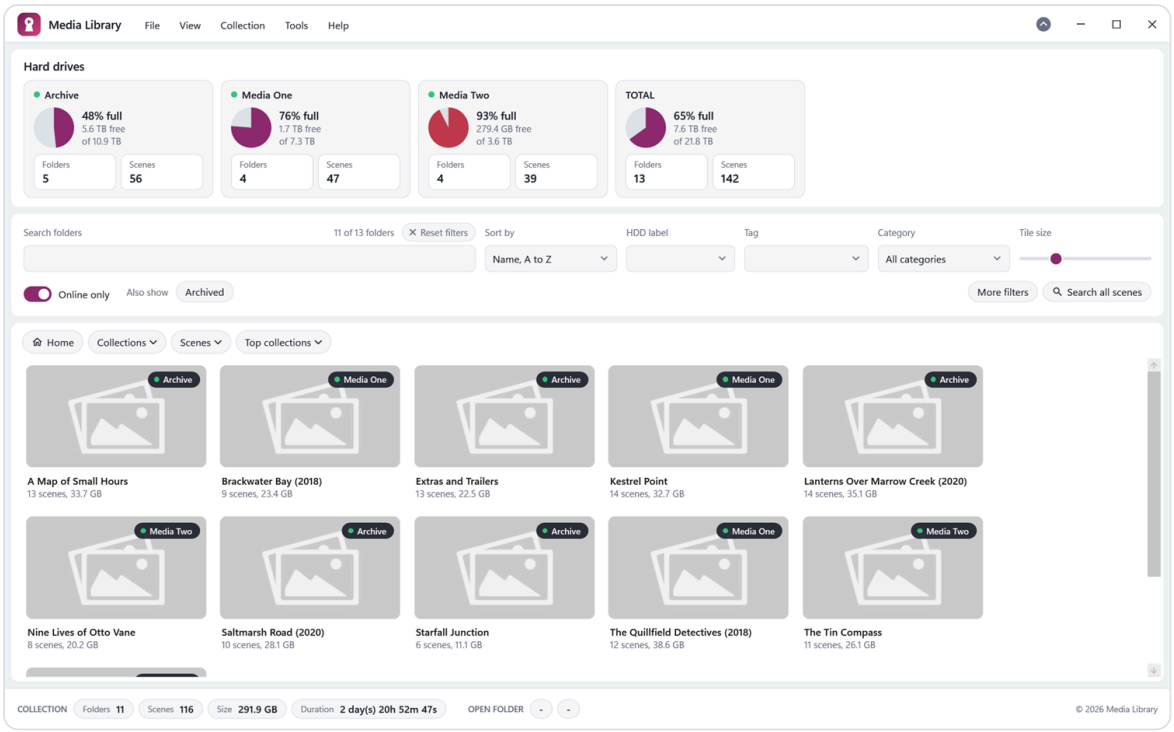


The Home view

> **Make Home your starting point**
> Go to **Settings** > **Display** and set **When the app opens** to **Show Home**.

Hard drives

Choose **View** > **Hard Drive Info** to see a panel listing each drive, how full it is, and how many folders and scenes it holds. Drives remembered in your catalogue are listed even while they're disconnected.



The Hard Drive Info panel above the folders

The status bar

The bar along the bottom shows the size of your collection, and the folder that's open. The arrow button at the top right shows or hides the filter panels, to give the tiles more room.

4. Finding folders

Searching

Type in **Search folders** to match folder names, drive labels, performers and folder tags. Start a word with a minus sign to exclude it, and press **Esc** to clear the search.

You type	You get
`sample`	Folders matching "sample"
`sample -archive`	Folders matching "sample", leaving out any that match "archive"

Sorting and filtering

Control	What it does
Sort by	Orders the tiles, for example by name, scenes, size or age
HDD label	Shows one drive's folders
Tag	Shows folders with a chosen tag
Category	Shows one category. See chapter 8
Online only	Shows only folders whose drive is connected
Also show	Switches on any Hidden categories you want to see
Tile size	Changes the tile size. Ctrl and the mouse wheel over the tiles does the same
Reset filters	Clears everything and shows all folders

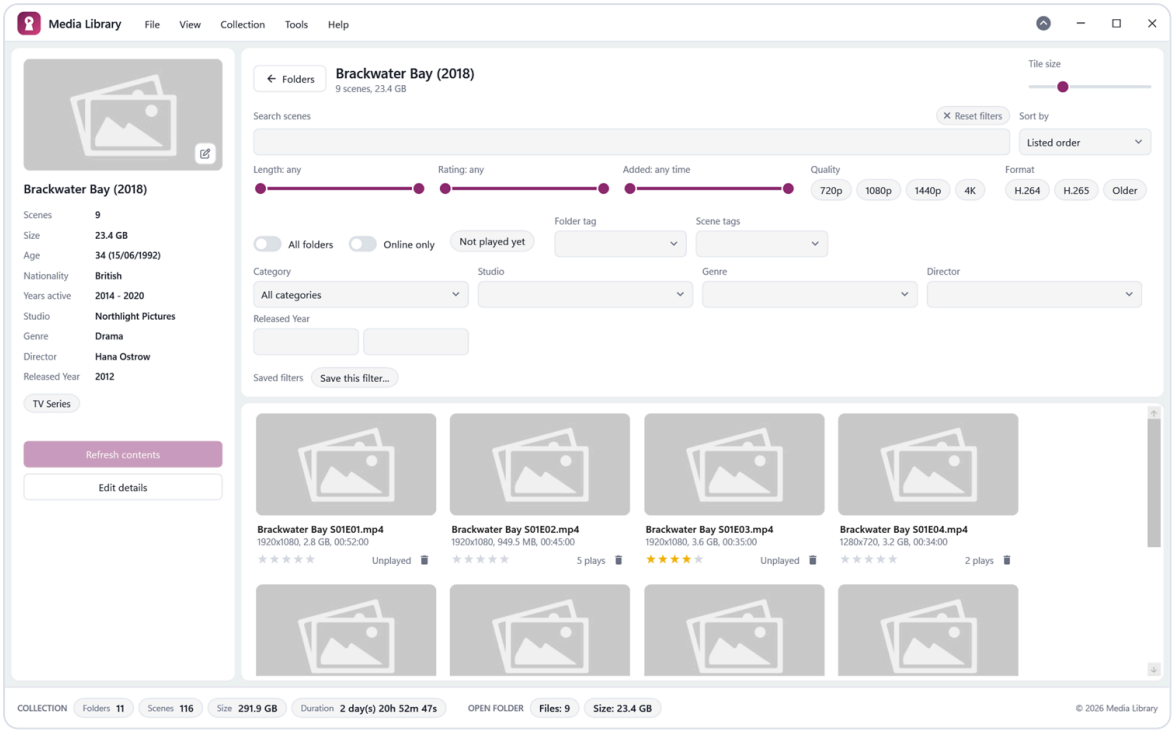
Performer filters narrows folders by performer name, nationality and year active. **Search all scenes** looks through every scene in your collection rather than folder names.

Ready-made lists

The buttons above the tiles open useful lists, such as 4K scenes rated 4 or more, 5-star scenes, scenes added in the last 30 days, and your largest folders.

5. Working with scenes

Click a folder tile to open it. Its details appear on the left, with its scenes beside them.



An open folder with its details and scenes

Playing and previewing

- **Play a scene** by clicking its picture. It opens in your default video player, and your play count goes up.
- **Preview a scene** by moving the mouse across its picture from left to right. You'll see moments from through the video.
- **Rate a scene** by clicking a star. Click the left half for half a star, or your current rating again to clear it.

Right-click a scene for more options, including its details and deleting it.

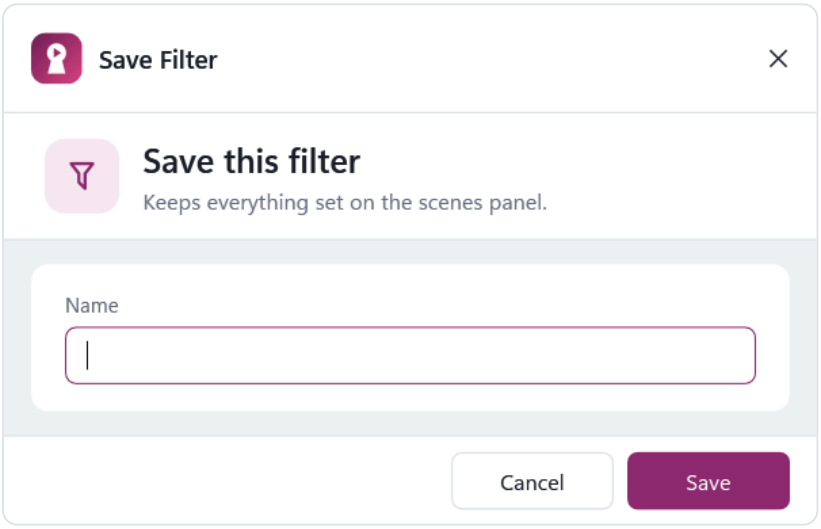
Filtering scenes

Search and sort are always on show. Click **Filters** for everything else. Each filter in use appears under the search box: click one to remove it, or click **Reset filters** to clear them all.

Control	What it does
Search scenes	Matches scene names and tags. A minus sign excludes a word
Sort by	Orders the scenes
Quality and **Format**	Limit scenes by picture size and video type
Range sliders	Narrow scenes by length, rating and how long ago they were added
All folders	Searches every scene instead of the open folder
Online only	Shows scenes whose drive is connected
Not played yet	Shows scenes you haven't watched
Folder tag and **Scene tags**	Limit scenes by tag. A scene matches if it has any of the chosen tags

Saved filters

Set up the filters you want, then click **Save this filter...** and give it a name. It appears under the search box, ready for one click. To remove one, right-click it and choose **Delete this filter**.

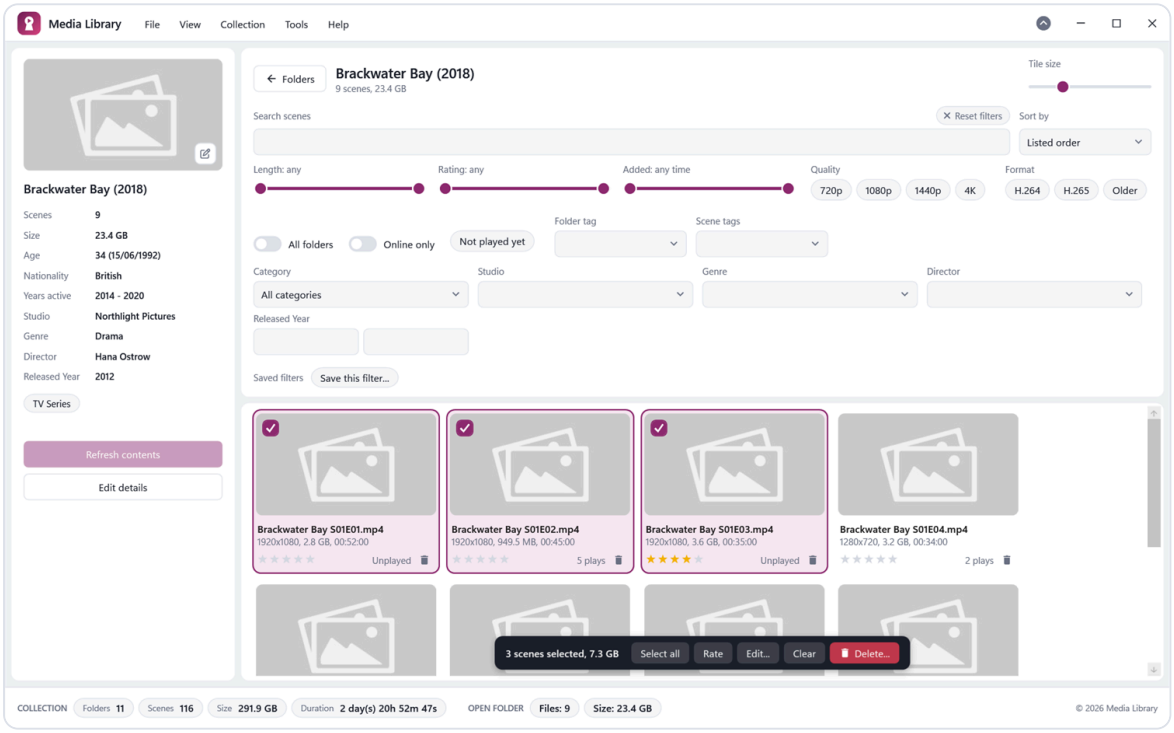


Naming a saved filter

6. Working with many scenes at once

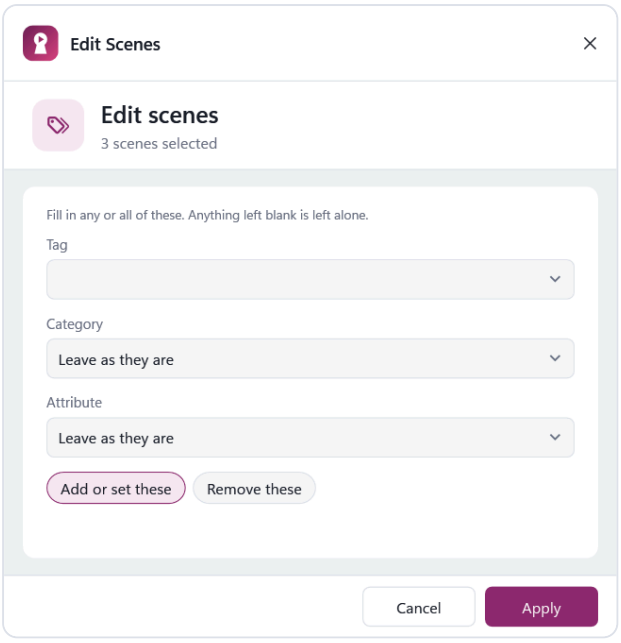
You can select scenes in several ways. A bar then appears at the bottom of the list, with what you can do to them.

To select	Do this
One scene	Click its tick box
Several scenes	Hold **Ctrl** and click each one
A run of scenes	Hold **Shift** and click the last one
An area	Drag a rectangle over the tiles, as you would in File Explorer
Everything shown	Press **Ctrl+A**
Nothing	Press **Esc**



Three scenes selected, with the action bar at the bottom

From the bar you can select all, rate the scenes, tag them or delete them. **Clear** cancels the selection.



Editing tags, categories and attributes across the selected scenes

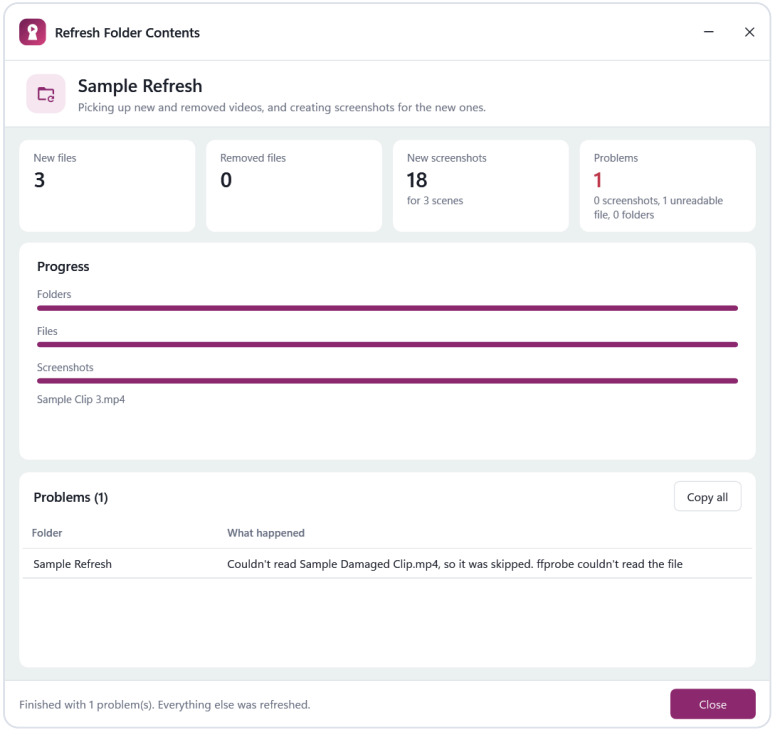
Deleting removes the file

Deleting a scene removes the video from its drive. Windows has no Recycle Bin on some removable and network drives, so a delete there is permanent. Media Library always asks first.

7. Keeping your collection up to date

Refreshing folders

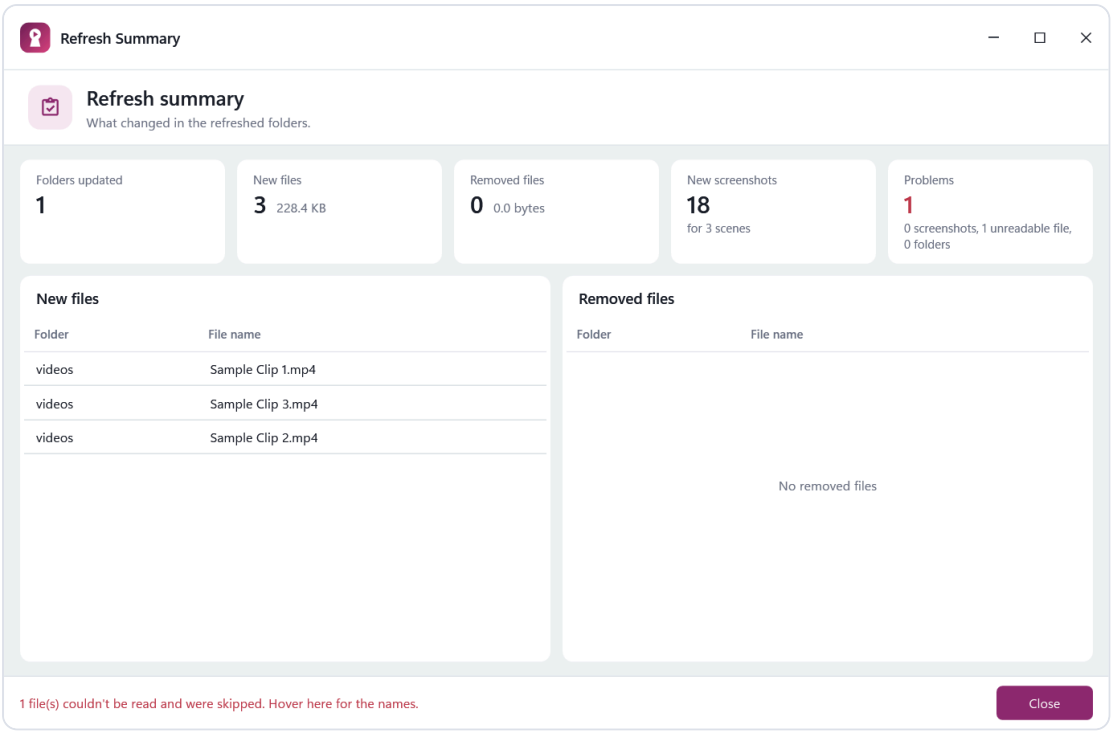
When videos change on disk, refresh to bring the catalogue up to date. You can refresh one folder by right-clicking it, or use **Collection > Refresh All Available Folders** for every connected drive.



A finished refresh, with one damaged file reported

Tile	What it counts
New files	Scenes added to the catalogue
Removed files	Scenes no longer on disk
New screenshots	Screenshots taken, for new scenes or for existing scenes that were missing them
Problems	Screenshots that failed, files that couldn't be read, and folders that couldn't be reached

A summary shows what changed when it finishes. If anything went wrong, the Refresh window stays open so you can read the details or use **Copy all**.



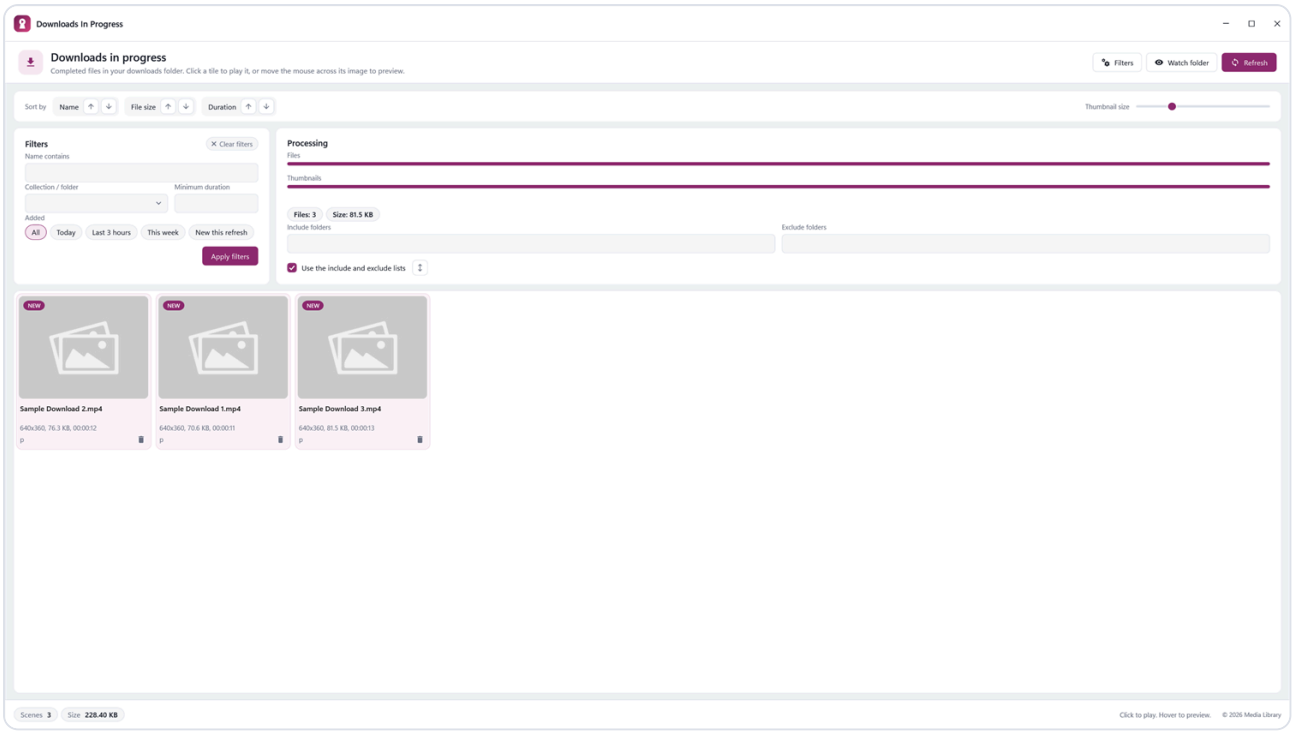
The refresh summary

Damaged videos

A file that can't be read is skipped, and everything else carries on. Your catalogue isn't affected.

Downloads

File > Downloads... shows completed videos in the `p` folder inside your Windows Downloads folder, so you can review them before they join your collection. Move the mouse across a tile to preview it, or click to play. New files are highlighted, and screenshots are taken in advance to save time when you import them.

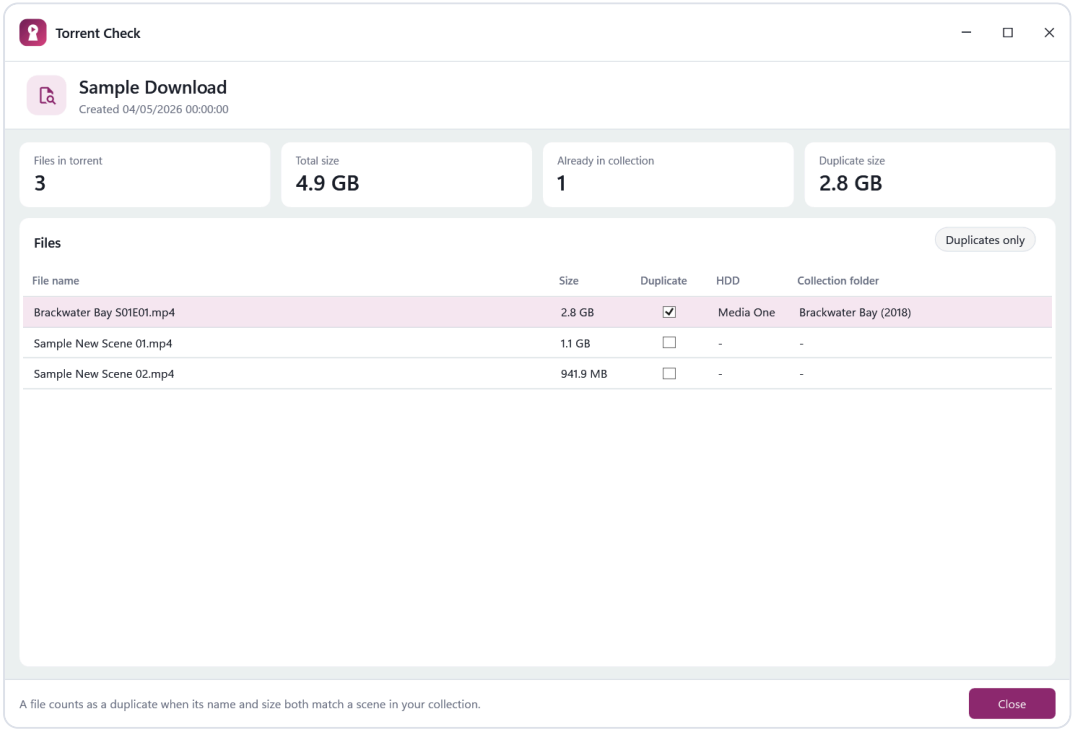


The Downloads window

Checking new files against your collection

These two tools show what you already have before you add more.

- **Tools > Torrent Check...** reads a torrent file and marks anything already in your catalogue.
- **Tools > Folder Duplicates...** compares a folder on disk with your catalogue.

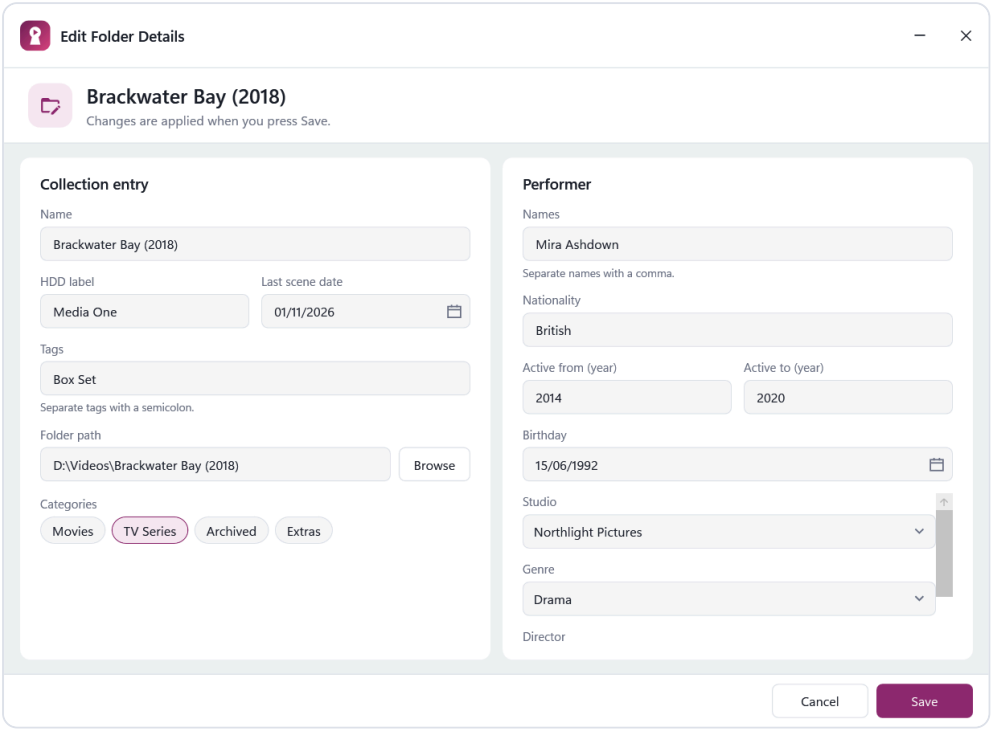


Torrent Check showing one file that's already in the collection

8. Organising your collection

Folder details

Right-click a folder and choose **Edit details…** to change its name, drive label, tags, categories and performer details. Changes apply when you click **Save**.

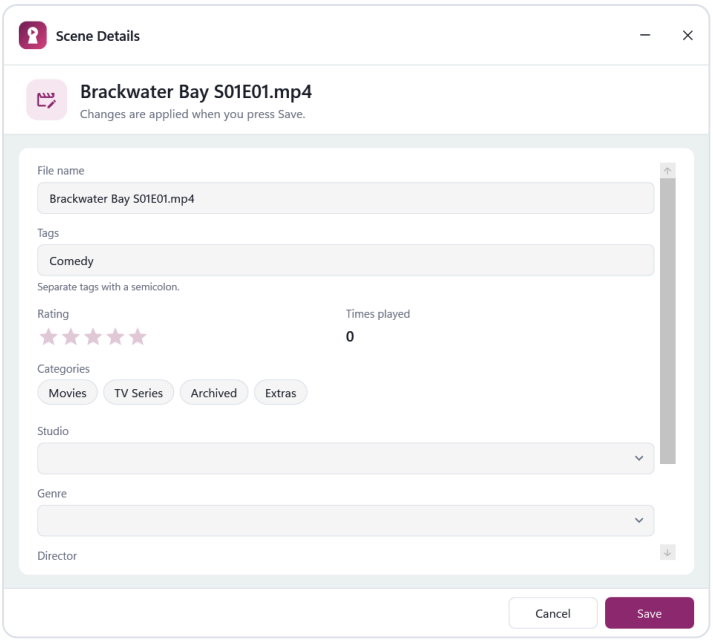


The Edit Folder Details window

The folder menu also lets you open the folder, open it in File Explorer, change its cover picture, rename it, refresh it, optimise or rebuild its screenshots, and remove it from your collection.

Scene details

Right-click a scene and choose **Scene info…** to change its name, tags and rating.



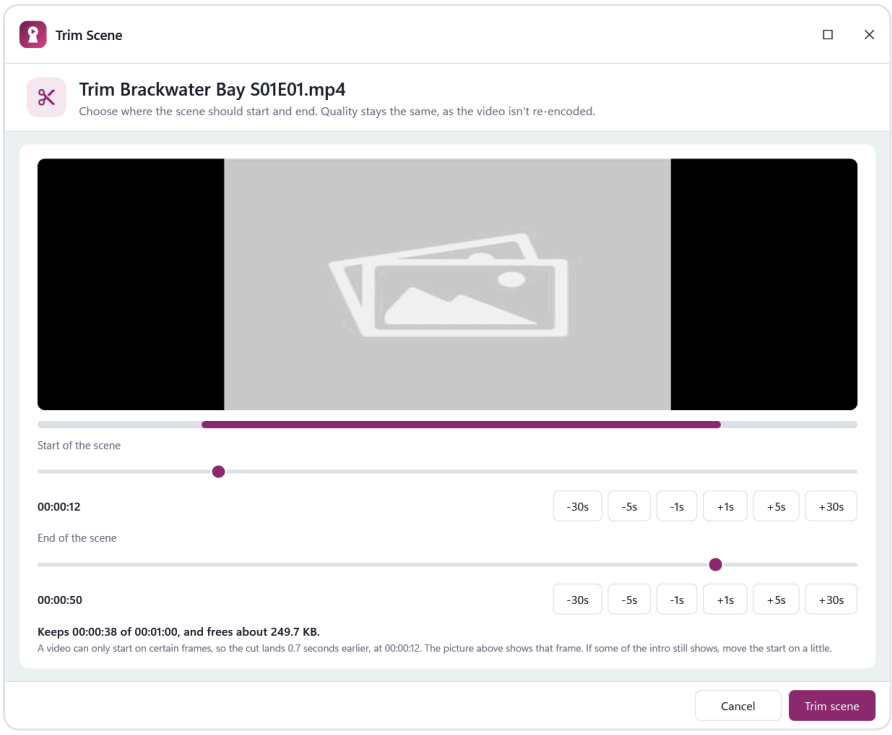
The Scene Details window

Trimming a scene

To cut an unwanted intro or ending from a video, right-click the scene and choose **Trim scene...**. Its drive must be connected. Move the sliders to choose where the scene starts and ends, using the picture as a guide. The scene keeps its name, rating, plays and details, and it's given new screenshots.

The video isn't re-encoded, so its quality doesn't change. A video can only start on certain frames, though, so the cut may land a few seconds before your mark. The window shows the frame it will really start on.

The new file is written and checked first, so the drive needs room for it. The original then goes to the Recycle Bin, and the space comes back when you empty the bin. On a drive with no Recycle Bin the original is deleted permanently, and the window says so before you commit.



Trim Scene, with the cut landing just before the mark

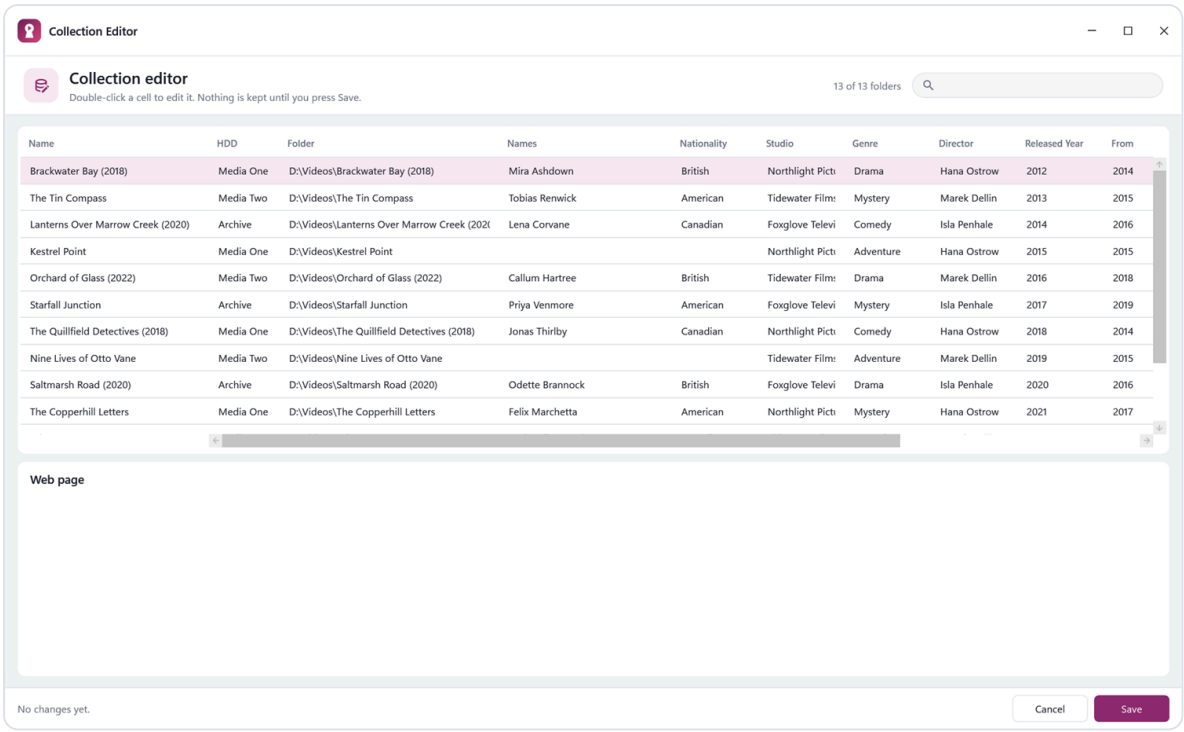
Categories

Categories are your own groups for folders. A folder can be in several. Create them in **Settings > Categories**, and tick them in Edit Folder Details.

Setting	Effect
Hidden	The category's folders stay out of the Folders list, Home and Surprise Me until you switch the category on with **Also show**
Switched off	The category and its scenes disappear from the whole app, except Settings

Collection Editor

Collection > Collection Editor... shows every folder in a table, which is the quickest way to update many at once. Search to narrow the list, edit in place, then save.

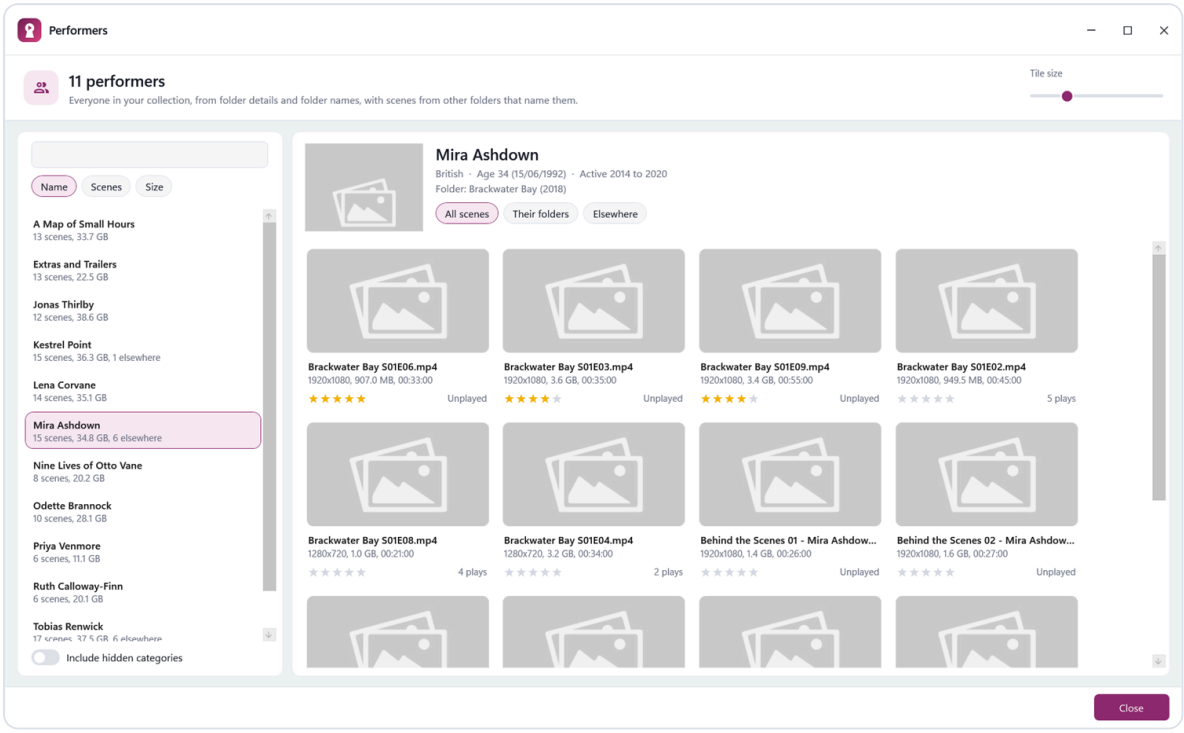


The Collection Editor

9. Exploring your collection

Performers

View > Performers... lists everyone in your collection, with their details and all their scenes.



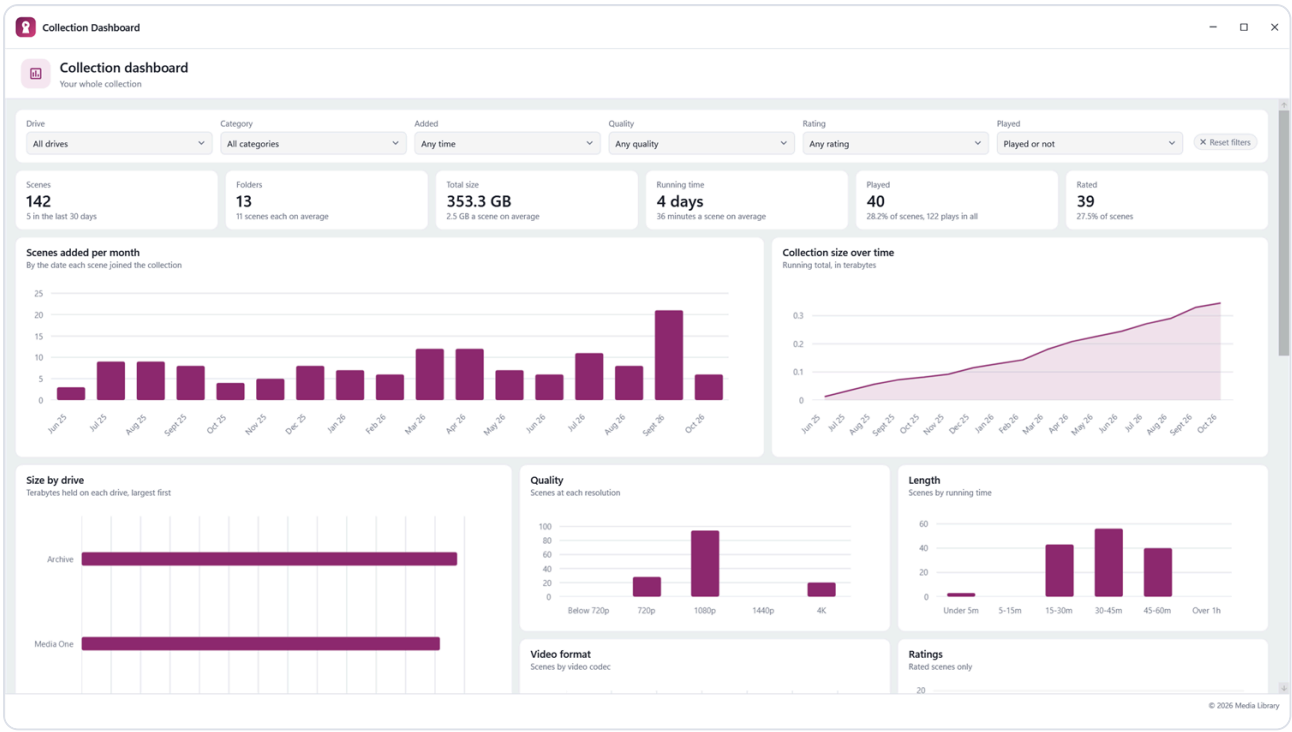
The Performers window

- Names come from each folder's performer details, or from the folder's name if those are empty.
- **Their folders** shows scenes in their own folders.
- **Elsewhere** shows scenes in other folders whose file names include their full name.
- Search, or sort by name, scene count or size.
- Hidden categories stay out of the list unless you switch on **Include hidden categories**.

> **Better details, better results**
> Adding performer names to your folders makes this window more accurate.

Dashboard

View > Dashboard... opens a dashboard of your collection. Use the filters along the top to focus on one drive, category, period, quality, rating or play status, and every chart updates to match.

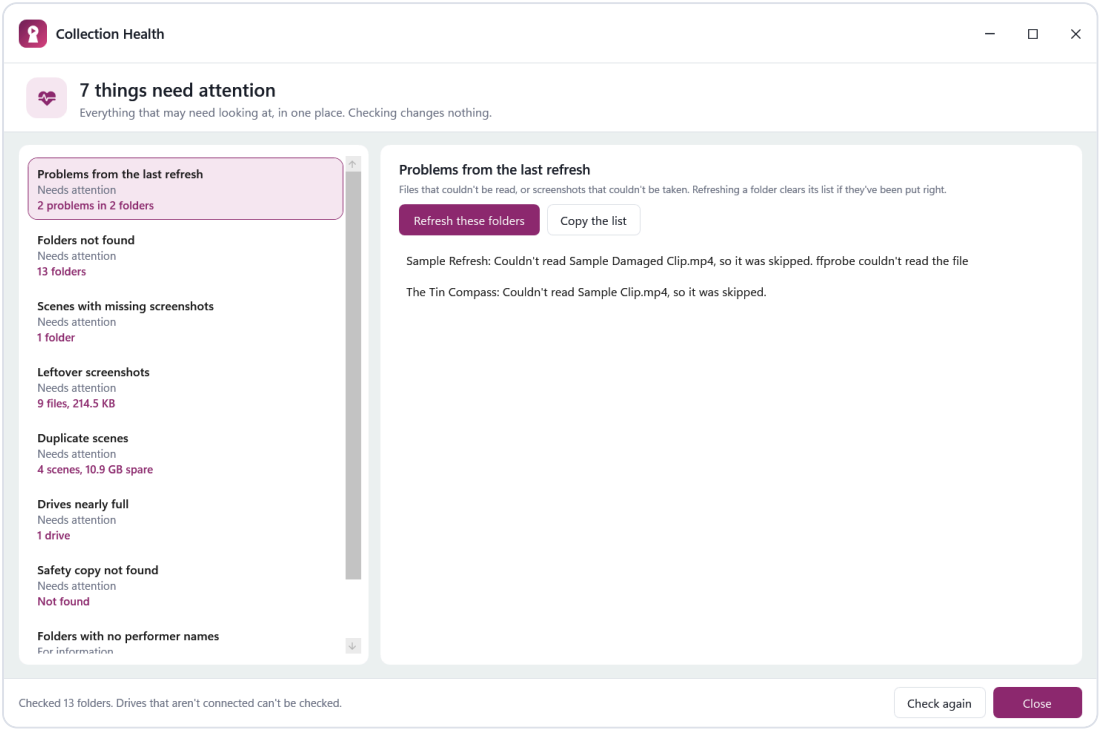


The Dashboard

10. Keeping things tidy

Collection Health

Collection > Collection Health... checks your whole collection and lists anything that may need attention. Checking changes nothing, and a bar shows how far it has got.



Collection Health

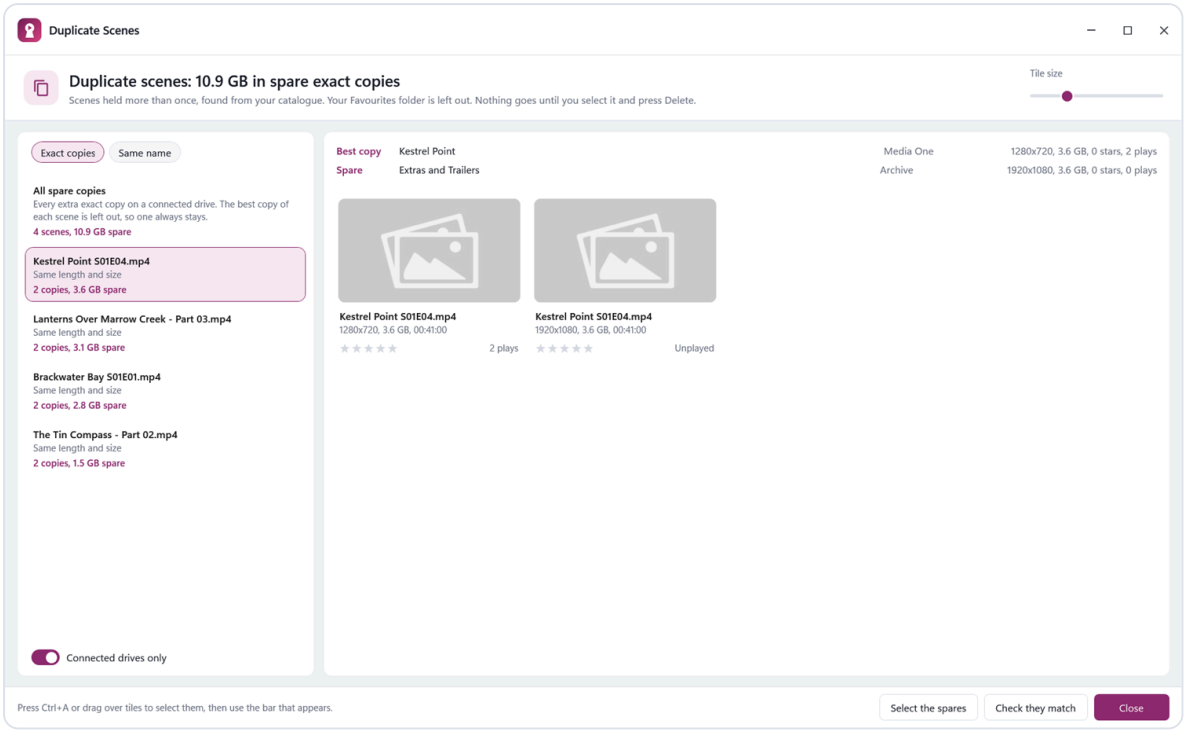
Choose a check on the left to see its details and, where it applies, a button that takes you to the fix.

Check	What it means
Problems from the last refresh	Files that couldn't be read, or screenshots that couldn't be taken
Folders not found	The drive is connected but the folder has moved
Missing screenshots	Refreshing the folder takes them again
Leftover screenshots	Screenshots of scenes no longer in your catalogue
Duplicate scenes	Scenes held more than once
Drives nearly full	Drives at 90% or more
Safety copy	Not set up, not found, or over 30 days old

Duplicate Scenes

Collection > Duplicate Scenes... finds scenes held more than once. The best copy of each is marked, going by rating, then plays or picture quality. Your Favourites folder is left out, as those copies are there on

purpose.



A group of copies, with the best one marked

Type	Meaning
Exact copies	The same length and the same size to the byte
Same name	The same name and length at different sizes, which is usually one scene encoded twice

1. Choose a group on the left.
2. Click **Check they match** to compare samples from the files.
3. Click **Select the spares**, then use the bar that appears to delete them.

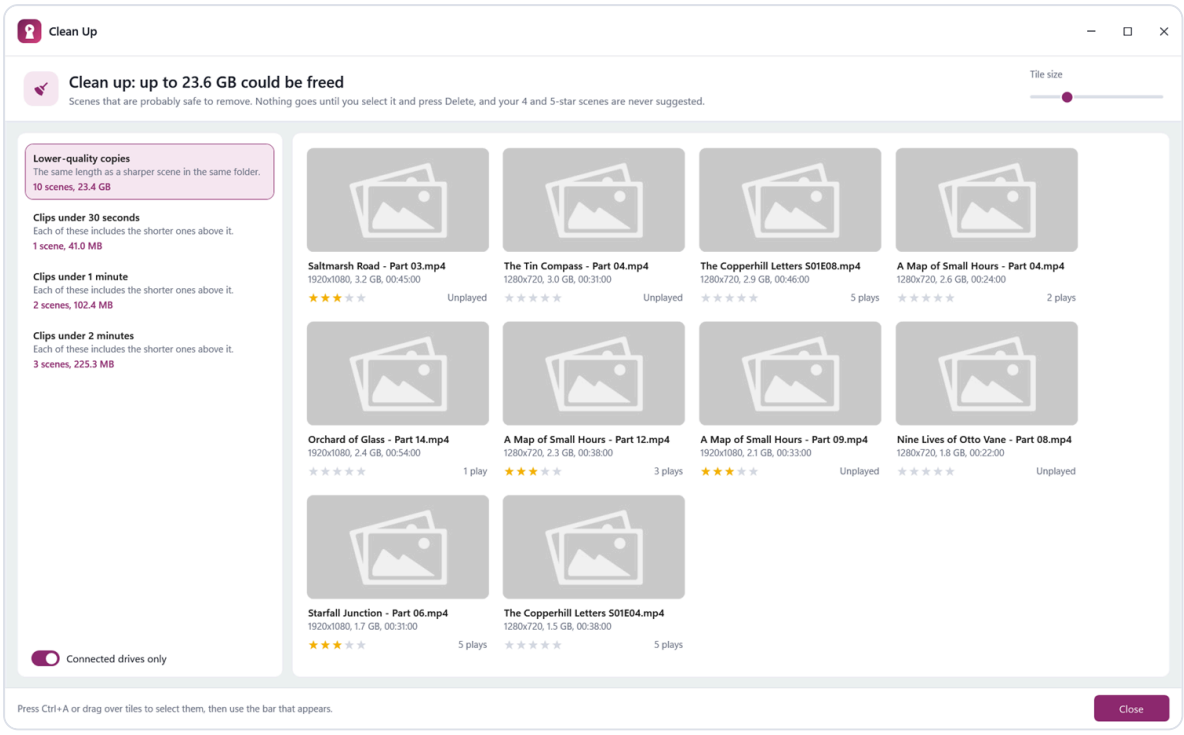
All spare copies lists every extra exact copy on your connected drives. The best copy of each scene is never included.

> **Check before deleting in bulk**
> Exact copies are matched from the catalogue, not by reading the files. Plays and tags on a deleted copy are lost, so start with a few groups.

Clean Up

Collection > Clean Up... suggests scenes you may want to remove, such as low ratings, lower-quality copies, very low resolution, old scenes you've never watched, and clips under 30 seconds, 1 minute or 2 minutes. Your 4 and 5-star scenes are never suggested.

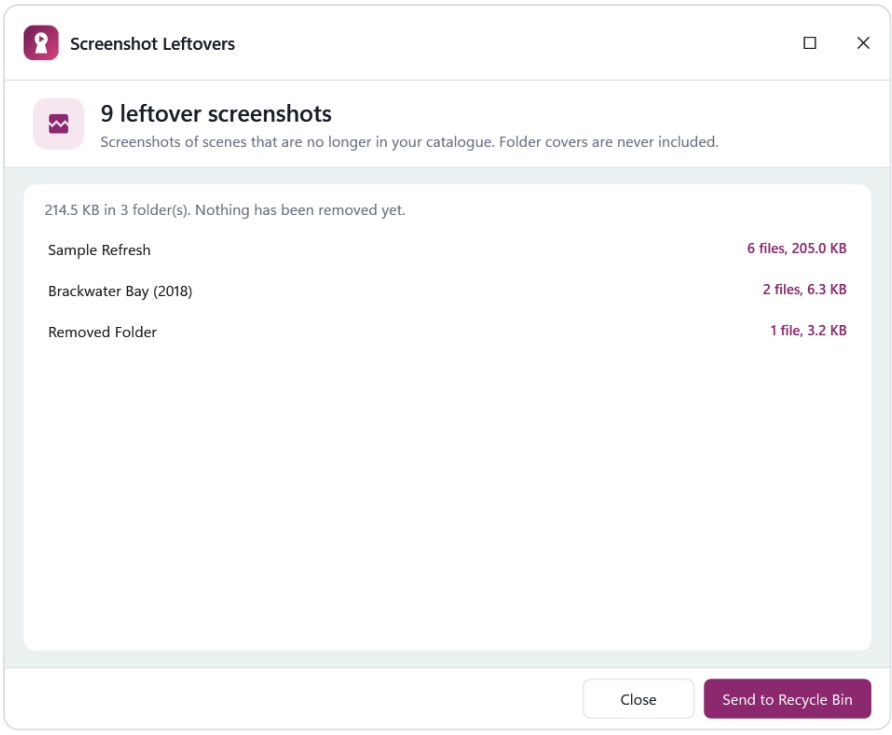
Choose a group, press **Ctrl+A** to select its scenes, and use the bar that appears.



Clean Up

Screenshot tools

Tool	Use it to
Tools > Screenshot Leftovers...	Find screenshots of scenes that have gone, and send them to the Recycle Bin
Edit screenshot advanced... (right-click a folder)	Choose a folder's cover from any moment of any of its scenes, at up to 1920 by 1080. Its drive must be connected
Rebuild screenshots... (right-click a folder)	Take new screenshots for a folder. Its drive must be connected, and its cover is kept
Collection > Rebuild All Screenshots...	Check every scene and retake only those without a strip, or with pictures smaller than their video could fill. Choose which connected drives to process, and stop at any time: running it again carries on from there
Tools > Optimise Screenshots	Convert older scenes to the two-file format, using the screenshots they already have, so their drives don't need to be connected. A scene that's missing any of its six screenshots is left for a refresh to complete
Tools > Clean Up Old Backups...	Remove old automatic catalogue backups



Screenshot Leftovers

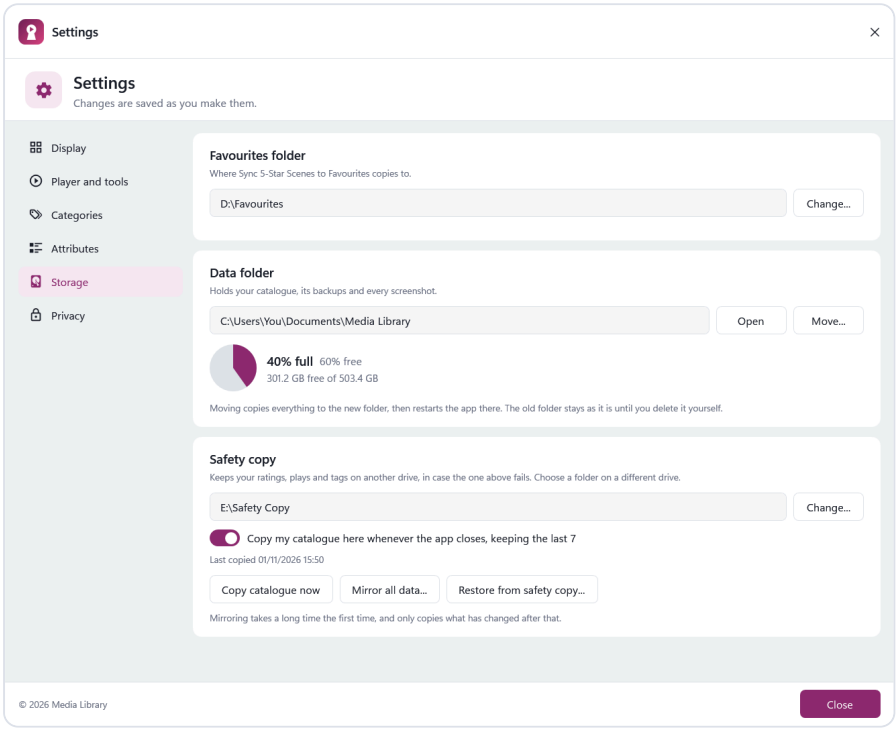
11. Keeping your data safe

Your videos are on your drives, but your ratings, plays and tags exist only in your catalogue. Keeping a copy of it is well worth a minute of setup.

Safety copy

Go to **Settings > Storage** and choose a folder on another drive. You can then:

- Copy the catalogue whenever the app closes, keeping the last seven copies.
- Copy it now.
- Mirror all your data, including screenshots. The first mirror can take a long time, and after that only changes are copied. Progress shows the speed and time left.



Settings: Storage

Moving your data

To keep your catalogue and screenshots on another drive, use **Move...** under **Data folder** in **Settings > Storage**. The app copies everything, then restarts using the new location. Your old folder isn't touched, so you can delete it once you're happy.

Restoring from your safety copy

Click **Restore from safety copy...** in **Settings > Storage**, and choose a dated catalogue or your full mirror. A catalogue brings back your ratings, plays, tags and categories. The full mirror brings back everything, including screenshots, copying only what differs.

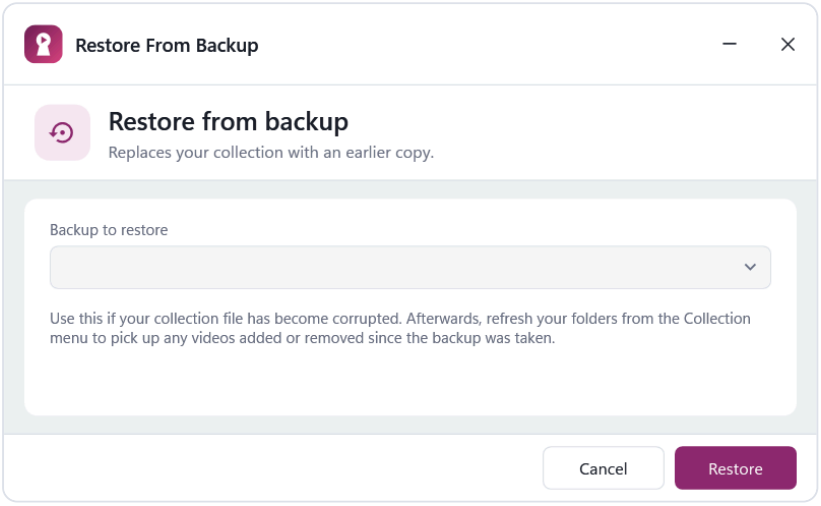
1. Close any other Media Library windows.

2. Choose what to restore, then click **Restore**. The copy is checked before anything changes.
3. Confirm. Progress shows the speed and time left, and **Stop** leaves your catalogue as it was.
4. The app restarts. Refresh your folders to pick up anything added or removed since the copy was made.

> **Your current data is kept**
> What you had before is saved in a `before-restore` folder inside your data folder. If the copy had a PIN set, that PIN applies after restoring.

Restoring a backup

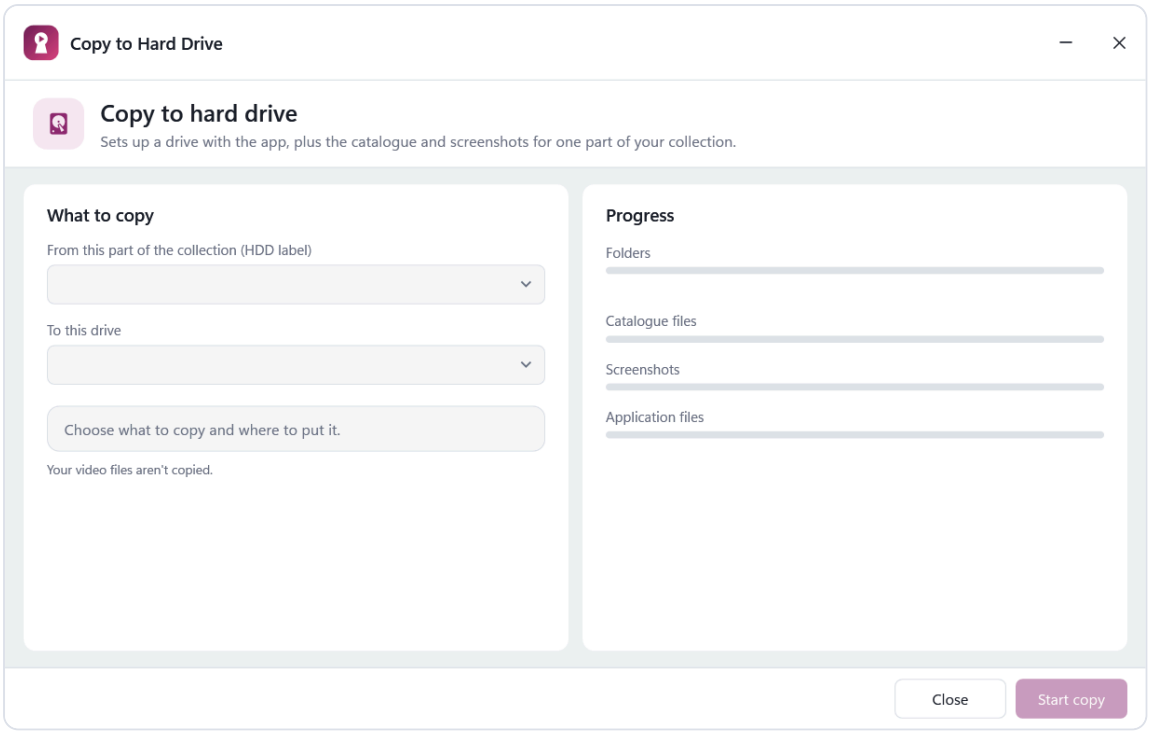
If your catalogue is ever empty or damaged when the app starts, it offers to list your recent backups from the data folder. Choose one, then refresh your folders to pick up anything added since.



Restoring from a backup

Copying to a hard drive

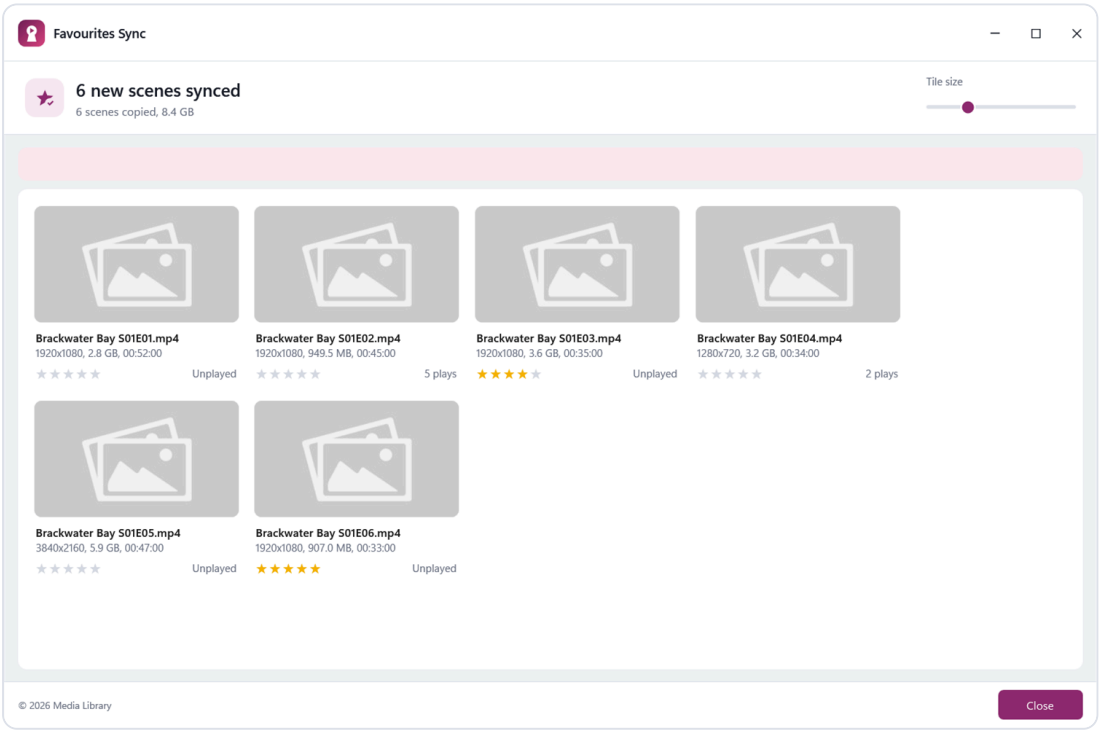
Tools > Initialise HDD Cache... sets up a drive with the app, plus the catalogue and screenshots for part of your collection. You can then browse that part on another PC, as a read-only copy. Your video files aren't copied.



Copy to Hard Drive

Favourites sync

Tools > Sync 5-Star Scenes to Favourites copies your 5-star scenes to one folder, for example on a portable drive. A card shows progress, speed and time left, and how much room is left on the drive. A results window then shows what was copied.

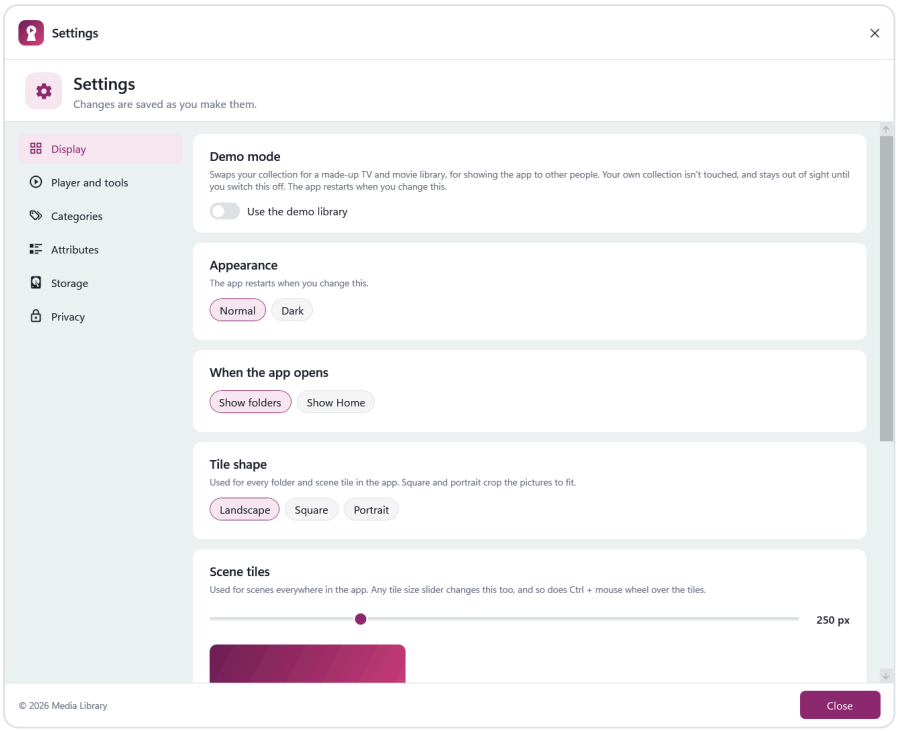


The results of a Favourites sync

12. Settings

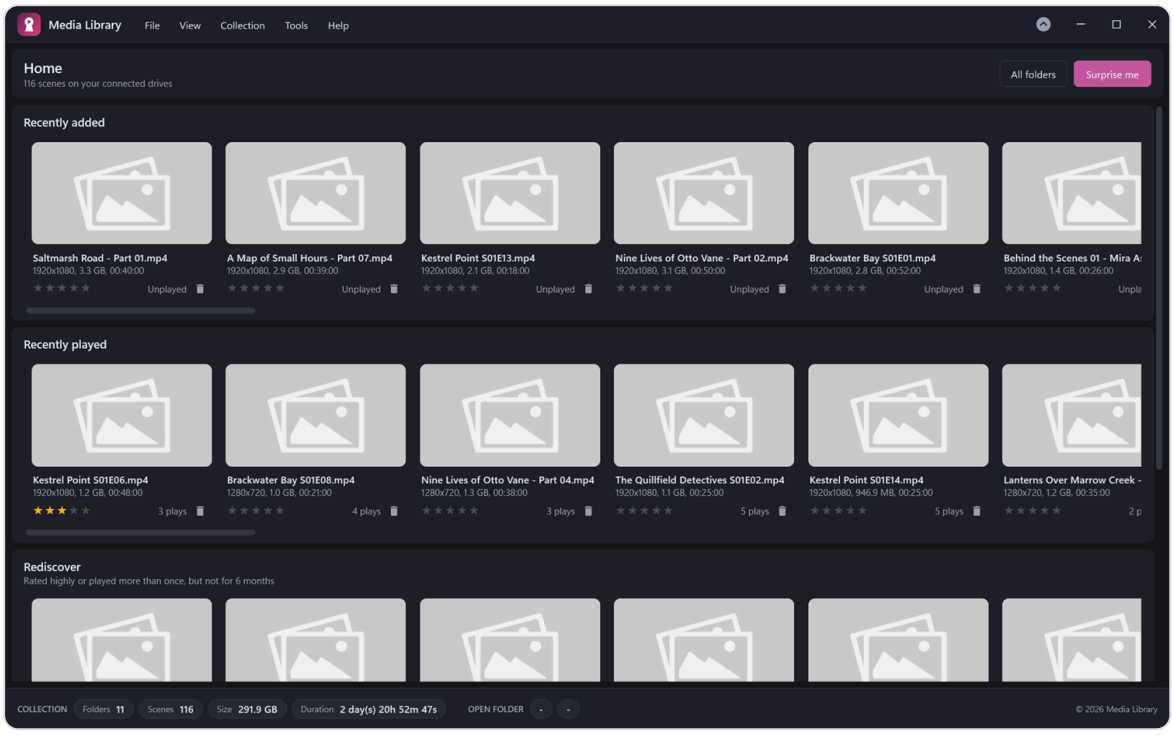
Open **File > Settings...**. Changes are saved as you make them.

Display



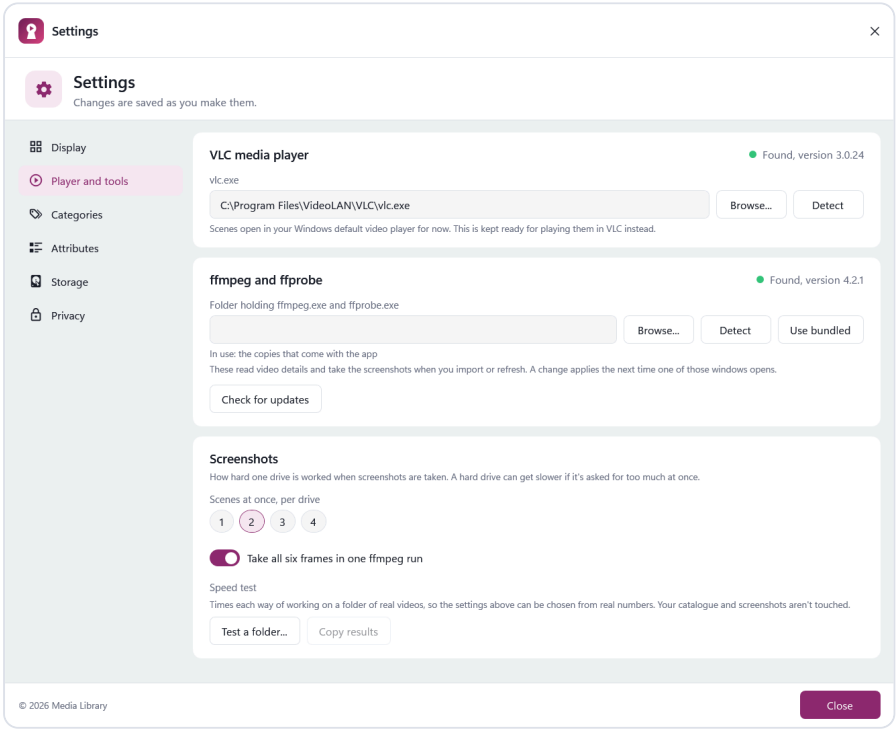
Settings: Display

Setting	What it does
Demo mode	Swaps your collection for a made-up library, for showing the app to other people. Your own collection stays out of sight, and the app restarts
Appearance	Chooses Normal or Dark. The app restarts
When the app opens	Starts on your folders or on Home
Tile shape	Landscape, Square or Portrait, across the whole app
Scene tiles and **Folder tiles**	Set the size of each, with a preview



Home in Dark appearance

Tools



Settings: Tools

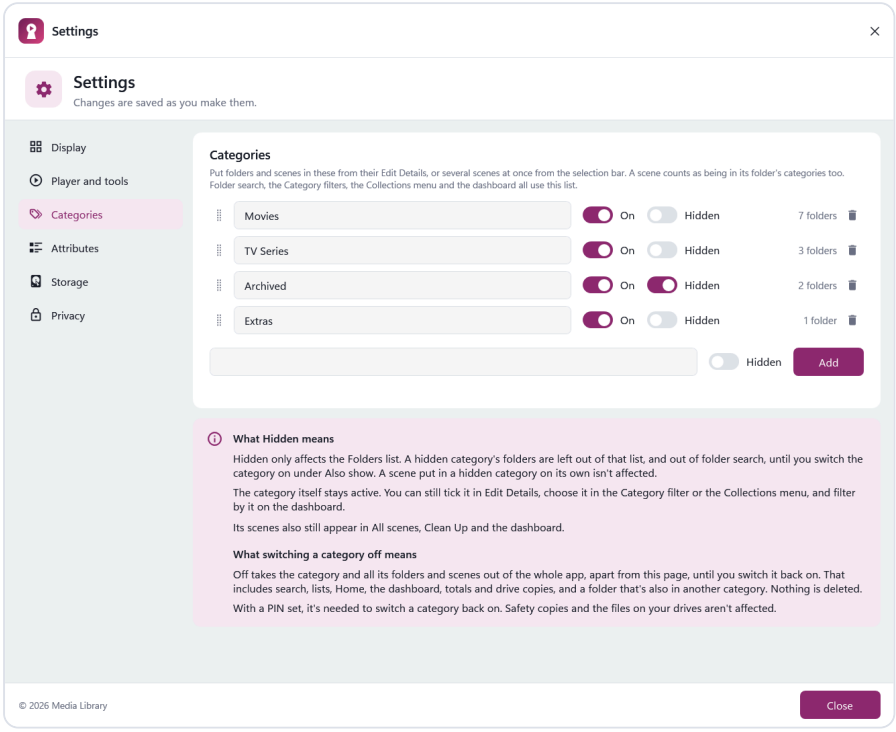
- **VLC media player** shows where VLC is, if you have it. Scenes currently open in your Windows default player.
- **ffmpeg and ffprobe** read your videos and take screenshots. They aren't included with the app: see chapter 2. **Check for updates** tells you if there's a newer version and can open its download page. It

never downloads anything itself. To use a new version, unpack it and click **Browse...** to choose its `bin` folder.

- **Screenshots** sets how many scenes each drive works on at once. **Test a folder...** times the options on your own videos, so you can pick the fastest for your drives.

Categories

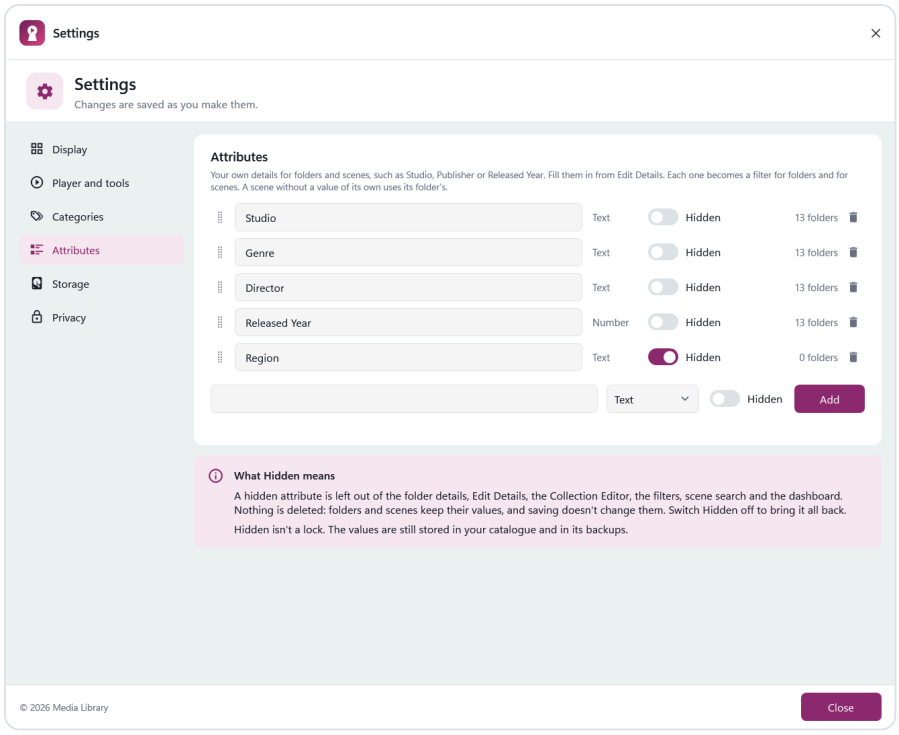
Add, reorder and remove categories, and choose whether each one is on, off or Hidden. If you delete a category that's in use, the app warns you first, then removes it from those folders.



Settings: Categories

Attributes

Add details of your own to keep on folders and scenes, such as Studio, Genre or Released Year, as text, a number or a date. Drag them into the order you want. **Hidden** takes an attribute out of view without changing the values held, and the count beside each one shows how many folders use it.



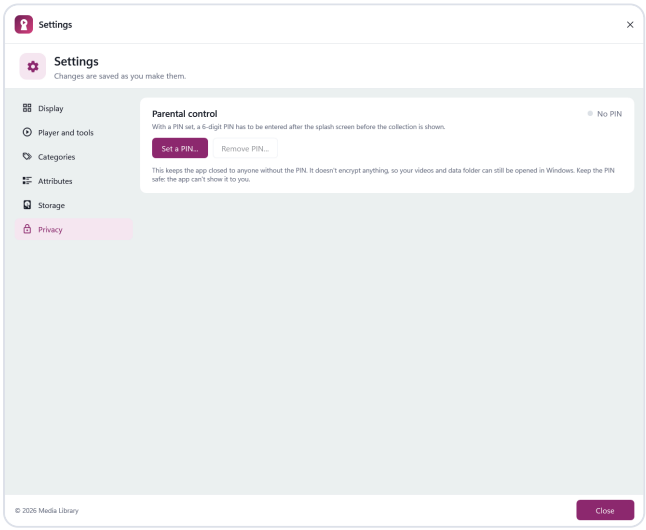
Settings: Attributes

Storage

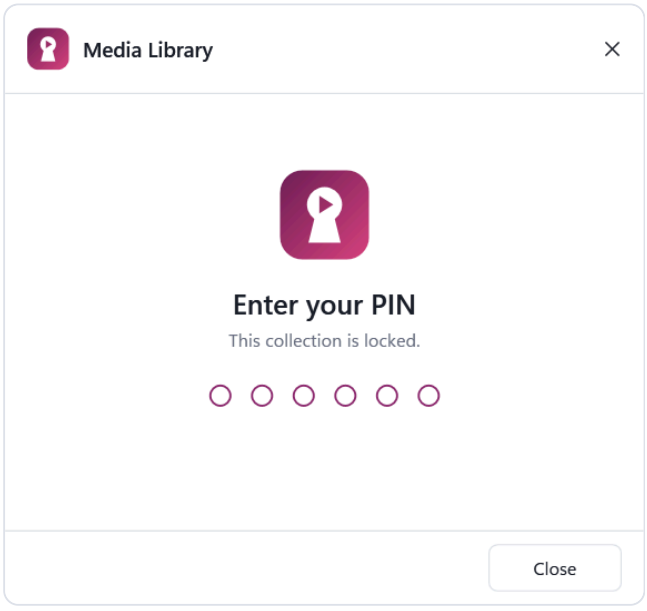
Your Favourites folder, your data folder and your safety copy. See chapter 11.

Privacy

Set a six-digit PIN to lock the app when it starts. Nothing in your collection is shown until the PIN is entered. Switching a category back on also needs the PIN.



Settings: Privacy



The PIN screen at start-up

Keep your recovery key safe
Setting a PIN encrypts your catalogue, and you're shown a recovery key once. If you forget your PIN, click **Forgotten it?** and enter that key. Without either one, the catalogue can't be opened. Screenshots and the rest of your data folder aren't encrypted.

To stop the app looking for updates when it starts, switch off **Check for updates when the app starts**. The check shows GitHub your internet address, and nothing about your collection is sent.

13. Help and reference

Keyboard and mouse

Keys	Action
Ctrl + mouse wheel	Change the tile size
Ctrl+A	Select all the scenes shown
Ctrl + click, **Shift** + click	Add to a selection, or select a run
Drag over tiles	Select an area
Delete	Delete the selected scenes, after asking
Esc	Clear a selection or a search

Troubleshooting

What you see	What to do
A folder's tiles are dimmed	Its drive isn't connected. Connect it and the folder is available again
"This scene's file can't be found"	Check the drive is connected, then refresh the folder in case the file moved
A file "couldn't be read"	The video may be damaged. Try playing it. It's skipped until a later refresh can read it
Screenshots are missing	Refresh the folder. If the problem stays, see **Collection Health** for the reason, or try a newer ffmpeg
Screenshots take a long time	Try the speed test in **Settings > Tools**
"Close the other windows first"	Close any other Media Library windows, then try again
The drive is full during a sync	The sync copies as many scenes as there's room for, in order

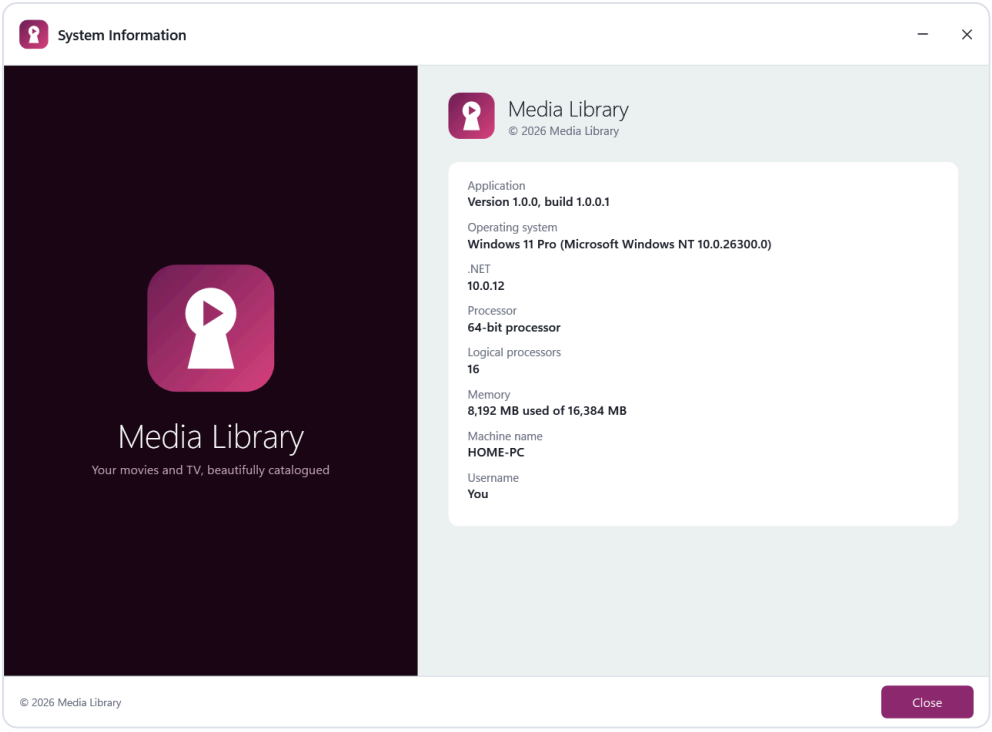
System Information

Help > User Guide opens this guide.

Updates

When a new version is published, a button in the status bar offers it. **Help > Check for Updates...** looks straight away. Choose **Download and install** and the app downloads the update, checks it, closes and runs the installer. Your collection isn't touched, and nothing is installed unless you ask.

Help > **System Information...** shows details of the app and your PC, which are useful if you ever need support. **Help** > **About...** shows the version and the size of your collection.



System Information